

Free & Low-Cost Clinics & Health Insurance

No insurance, or can't afford a doctor? You can still get care. Federal health centers see everyone regardless of ability to pay, and you may qualify for free or low-cost coverage. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Federally funded health centers must see you regardless of insurance or income — you pay on a sliding scale, sometimes nothing. And many people who think they can't get insurance actually qualify for free or low-cost coverage.

1 Get Care Without Insurance

These centers and clinics provide medical, dental, and mental health care on a sliding scale based on income.

☐ HRSA Health Center Finder

Official federal directory of community health centers that must see everyone, regardless of ability to pay.
→ findahealthcenter.hrsa.gov

☐ NeedyMeds — Free Clinics

A national directory of free and low-cost clinics staffed by volunteers.
→ www.needymeds.org/free-clinics

☐ 211 — Local Health Help

Call or search for free clinics and health programs in your area.
→ www.211.org or dial 211

2 Get Free or Low-Cost Insurance

You may qualify for free coverage through Medicaid, or low-cost plans with big subsidies through the marketplace.

☐ Medicaid & CHIP

Free or very low-cost coverage for people with limited income, and for children. Apply any time of year.
→ www.medicaid.gov/about-us/where-can-people-get-help-medicaid-chip/index.html

☐ HealthCare.gov — Marketplace Plans

Compare plans and see if you qualify for subsidies that lower your premium — many people pay very little.
→ www.healthcare.gov

☐ Free Enrollment Help (Navigators)

Free, in-person help understanding and signing up for coverage.
→ localhelp.healthcare.gov

3 Other Ways to Get Seen

Additional low-cost options for checkups, screenings, and care.

☐ Planned Parenthood

Low-cost reproductive and general health services on a sliding scale.

→ www.plannedparenthood.org

☐ Free Health Screenings

Many health centers and pharmacies offer free blood pressure, diabetes, and cancer screenings. Ask your local health center.

→ Ask your local health center

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

You don't need to use expensive urgent-care or ER visits for routine needs. Community health centers cost far less and offer ongoing care — and emergency rooms must treat you regardless of ability to pay.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

When you call a health center, ask about their “sliding fee scale” and bring proof of income — your visit may cost very little or nothing. Many also have staff who help you apply for Medicaid on the spot.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need local clinic or coverage help?

This guide covers national starting points. For clinics, free screenings, and enrollment help near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
